



PRESENCE & GRACE

*Clothe yourselves with
compassion, kindness, humility,
gentleness, and patience.
Colossians 3:12*



Camellia

WEEK FIVE

PRESENCE & GRACE

Opening Prayer

Heavenly Father,

You created me to reflect Your presence and
grace in a special way. Help me to remain in You,
that I may always be a source of Your presence
and grace to those around me.

Amen.

*Clothe yourselves with compassion,
kindness, humility, gentleness, and patience.
Colossians 3:12*



Song for Reflection:
The Swan - Saint-Saëns



OUR GUIDE

St. Cecilia

The Heavenly Songstress



*"I carry a secret in my heart that keeps me
always singing."*

THEIR STORY

- ✦ **Early Life:** Born around 200 AD to a noble Roman family. Given in marriage to a pagan man, Valerian — though she had already promised her heart to the Lord.
- ✦ **The Song in Her Heart:** On her wedding day, while musicians played, Cecilia sang her own song — to God, in her heart. This is why she became patroness of music.
- ✦ **Conversion of Valerian:** She told him an angel protected her. He asked to see it; she said he must first be baptized. Upon returning, he saw her praying with an angel beside her, flaming wings outstretched. The angel crowned them both with lilies and roses.
- ✦ **Witness and Martyrdom:** Valerian and his brother were martyred for burying Christians. Cecilia was eventually captured. Multiple attempts on her life failed; the final left her alive for three days, during which she prayed and preached to many.
- ✦ **Her Legacy:** Cecilia's beauty wasn't defined by adornment — it was defined by essence. The quiet radiance of a soul attuned to God. She shows us that essence isn't something we wear — it's a tone of being. Her feast day is November 22nd.

THE PRESENCE OF YOUR SONG

- ✦ In music, presence is what a performer brings into the room before she plays a single note. The posture, the breath, the stillness — the air around her changes. The song has not started yet, and already something is being communicated.
- ✦ Your Style Essence is the presence you carry into every room. Not your outfit. Not your mood. The quality of you — the particular way God's light moves through your countenance, your carriage, your way of being seen.
- ✦ It is not performance. It is not personality. It is the outward expression of an inward harmony — what happens when the spirit God placed in you meets the body He gave you to carry it.
- ✦ God did not give every woman the same presence. He gave you a particular one — bold or gentle, radiant or ethereal, warm or still — and it was no accident. Your presence is meant to tell the world something true about Him that no one else can tell in quite that way.
- ✦ Like St. Cecilia, whose quiet courage filled rooms before she ever spoke, your presence can become a song of love to the Lord — not through what you wear, but through what you carry.

AN OVERVIEW

What is Sacred Style Essence?

This week's exploration introduces the Sacred Style Essence framework — seven archetypal expressions of beauty, each capturing a unique way grace moves through you. Most women are a blend of two or three essences, with one or two being dominant.

These essences are not fashion categories or personality boxes. They are reflections — ways the infinite facets of God's character shine through His daughters.

The Flame: Bold, striking, and confident — communicates presence through strength and clarity.

The Keeper: Relaxed, authentic, and approachable — conveys grace through ease and warmth.

The Sage: Balanced, refined, and poised — embodies grace through harmony and proportion.

The Spark: Lively, expressive, and creative — radiates grace through joy and energy.

The Heart: Soft, gentle, and inviting — reveals grace through tenderness and sensitivity.

The Grace: Youthful, innocent, and light — shines with grace through purity and sweetness.

The Veil: Delicate, otherworldly, and luminous — manifests grace through stillness and spiritual beauty.

THE FLAME

Reflecting God's Bold Truth

You carry the energy of holy boldness. Like Deborah leading Israel or John the Baptist crying out in the wilderness, your presence commands attention and speaks truth without apology. God's power and righteousness shine through your angular strength and dramatic presence.

What You Reflect: God's righteous power, His justice, His uncompromising truth

Your Presence: Purposeful and direct — you walk like you know where you're going

Your Energy: Like a fire — intense, consuming, impossible to ignore

In Scripture: Deborah, Esther — bold leaders who changed history

Style Expression: Bold lines, striking contrasts, architectural silhouettes, statement pieces that command a room

"The Lord gives the word; the women who announce the news are a great host." — Psalm 68:11

THE KEEPER

Reflecting God's Faithful Creation

You carry the energy of holy groundedness. Like Ruth gleaning in the fields or the woman of Proverbs 31 tending her household, your presence brings authenticity and ease. God's creativity in nature — unhurried, organic, perfectly imperfect — shines through your relaxed warmth.

What You Reflect: God's creative abundance, His faithfulness to creation, His organic artistry

Your Presence: Easy and unhurried — you move with natural, relaxed rhythm

Your Energy: Like a forest — grounded, breathing, alive with quiet life

In Scripture: Ruth, the Proverbs 31 woman — faithful, hardworking, grounded

Style Expression: Natural textures, earthy tones, relaxed silhouettes, nothing fussy or overdone

"She considers a field and buys it; out of her earnings she plants a vineyard." — Proverbs 31:16

THE SAGE

Reflecting God's Timeless Order

You carry the energy of holy reverence. Like the noble women of Scripture who understood the weight of tradition and the dignity of their calling, your presence brings calm authority and timeless grace. God's perfect order — balanced, enduring, refined through ages — shines through your composed elegance.

What You Reflect: God's eternal nature, His perfect order, His unchanging faithfulness

Your Presence: Measured and graceful — controlled, never rushed or sloppy

Your Energy: Like a cathedral — ordered, reverent, standing through centuries

In Scripture: Elizabeth, Anna — dignified women of faith and wisdom

Style Expression: Timeless silhouettes, quality over trend, refined simplicity, dignified elegance

"Strength and dignity are her clothing, and she laughs at the time to come." — Proverbs 31:25

THE SPARK

Reflecting God's Holy Joy

You carry the energy of holy delight. Like Miriam dancing after the Red Sea crossing or David leaping before the Ark, your presence brings unexpected joy and sacred playfulness. God's delight in creation — surprising, whimsical, full of holy mischief — shines through your spirited energy.

What You Reflect: God's joy, His delight in creation, His holy playfulness

Your Presence: Quick and animated — lots of gesture, energy in motion

Your Energy: Like fireworks — bright, surprising, delightfully unpredictable

In Scripture: Miriam, Tabitha — joyful, active, full of life

Style Expression: Unexpected combinations, playful details, youthful energy, mixing high and low

"Then Miriam the prophetess took a tambourine in her hand, and all the women went out after her with tambourines and dancing." — Exodus 15:20

THE HEART

Reflecting God's Tender Love

You carry the energy of holy tenderness. Like the woman who anointed Jesus with costly perfume or Mary holding her Son, your presence brings warmth and sensory richness. God's nurturing love — soft, abundant, enveloping — shines through your gentle curves and warm spirit.

What You Reflect: God's tender mercy, His nurturing heart, His abundant love

Your Presence: Flowing and gentle — soft movements, unhurried grace

Your Energy: Like a hearth — warm, glowing, drawing others close

In Scripture: Mary Magdalene, the woman with the perfume — passionate devotion

Style Expression: Soft textures, flowing fabrics, warm colors, romantic details that invite closeness

*"As a mother comforts her child, so will I comfort you."
— Isaiah 66:13*

THE GRACE

Reflecting God's Pure Light

You carry the energy of holy innocence. Like the young Mary receiving Gabriel's message with simple trust, your presence brings gentle purity and quiet light. God's tender care for the lamb, the child, the humble heart — delicate, guileless, softly luminous — shines through your gentle spirit.

What You Reflect: God's gentleness, His care for the humble, His pure light

Your Presence: Light and delicate — small movements, gentle steps

Your Energy: Like morning light — soft, pure, gently illuminating

In Scripture: The young Mary, Hannah — simple trust, purity of heart

Style Expression: Soft colors, delicate details, gentle silhouettes, sweet without being saccharine

*"Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God."
— Matthew 5:8*

THE VEIL

Reflecting God's Holy Mystery

You carry the energy of holy transcendence. Like Mary of Bethany sitting at Jesus' feet or the contemplatives who spent lifetimes in prayer, your presence seems to come from somewhere beyond. God's ineffable mystery — otherworldly, luminous, not quite of this earth — shines through your ethereal quality.

What You Reflect: God's transcendence, His holy mystery, His infinite beauty

Your Presence: Floating and fluid — almost like you're moving through water

Your Energy: Like mist — present but not quite solid, suggesting depths beyond

In Scripture: Mary of Bethany — the contemplative at Jesus' feet

Style Expression: Flowing fabrics, ethereal colors, elongated silhouettes, pieces that seem to transcend trends

"Mary has chosen the better part, which will not be taken away from her." — Luke 10:42

DISCOVERING YOUR ESSENCE

Beginning the Journey

Note: Discovering your essence is a process of gentle observation, not rigid categorization.

Unlike color analysis, which has more objective markers, essence discovery requires patient reflection and honest observation. Most women carry a blend of two or three essences — one primary, one or two secondary. Your blend is unique to you.

THE MIRROR OF PRESENCE

Pause and Consider:

Think about the last time you felt completely, authentically yourself. Not performing, not trying, not adjusting for anyone else's expectations.

- Where were you?
- What were you wearing?
- How did you carry yourself?
- What energy did you bring to the space?

This is a glimpse of your true essence.

QUESTIONS FOR SELF-DISCOVERY

Answer these questions honestly. There are no right or wrong answers — only truth.

When you enter a room, people tend to notice your:

- Commanding energy?
- Approachable warmth?
- Quiet dignity?
- Lively spirit?
- Soft warmth?
- Sweet gentleness?
- Otherworldly quality?

Friends have described you as:

- *Striking, bold, intense, powerful?*
- *Genuine, relaxed, real, earthy?*
- *Elegant, refined, timeless, put-together?*
- *Fun, spirited, youthful, surprising?*
- *Warm, nurturing, soft, feminine?*
- *Sweet, gentle, delicate, kind?*
- *Mysterious, dreamy, unique, ethereal?*

QUESTIONS CONTINUED

When you're being fully yourself, your energy feels most like:

- *A fire — intense, consuming, impossible to ignore?*
- *A forest — grounded, breathing, alive with quiet life?*
- *A cathedral — ordered, reverent, standing through centuries?*
- *Fireworks — bright, surprising, delightfully unpredictable?*
- *A hearth — warm, glowing, drawing others close?*
- *Morning light — soft, pure, gently illuminating?*
- *Mist — present but not quite solid, suggesting depths beyond?*

The aspect of God's character that most draws you is:

- *His righteousness and justice — holy power that sets things right?*
- *His faithfulness and provision — the God who sustains all creation?*
- *His eternal wisdom — the unchanging I AM?*
- *His joy and delight — the God who invented laughter?*
- *His tender mercy — the God who comforts like a mother?*
- *His gentleness — the Good Shepherd, the Lamb?*
- *His transcendent mystery — the God beyond comprehension?*

KNOW THYSELF

Take the Sacred Style Essence quiz in your portal and record your blend here.

My Primary Essence:

My Secondary Essence(s):

This essence reflects a facet of God:

*(God's bold truth / faithful creation / timeless order /
holy joy / tender love / pure light / holy mystery)*



Does this blend feel like an obvious fit, or is there something unexpected about it? What does that tell you about how God has composed you to be present in the world?

KNOW THYSELF, CONTINUED

Reflect: Which essence felt like the most obvious confirmation of something you already knew about your presence — and which one surprised you?

Looking back at your Discovering Your Essence notes, what do you see differently now that you have language for your blend?

Is there a part of your presence you have been dimming, softening, or apologizing for — something this result is asking you to let shine instead?

BRING IT TO GOD

Begin with quiet reflection. Ask Jesus to help you see yourself with wonder — as part of His creation, radiant and intentional.

Pause in Prayer: Take a deep breath and invite the Lord into this moment. "Jesus, how do You reveal Your presence through mine?"

Receive: When was the last time someone was changed by simply being near you — not by what you said or did, but by the presence you brought into the room? What was God doing through you in that moment?

BRING IT TO GOD, CONTINUED

Bring It to Him: Is there a part of your presence you have been muting — a brightness, a gentleness, a steadiness that you've been told is "too much" or "not enough"? Bring that part to Him now. What do you sense Him saying back?

Inhabit It: Your essence reflects a particular facet of who God is. How might He be asking you to carry that facet of Him into the world this week — not by changing who you are, but by embodying it more fully?

*"Clothe yourselves with compassion, kindness,
humility, gentleness, and patience."
Colossians 3:12*

LIVING IT OUT

This week's practice is a simple invitation: to inhabit your essence for one day at a time.

Choose one day this week to intentionally embody your primary essence. Before the day begins, take a moment to pray:

"Lord, help me carry Your _____ into every room today."

Fill in the blank with the facet of God your essence reflects — His boldness, His ease, His order, His joy, His tenderness, His gentleness, His mystery.

Then, without performing, without trying, simply notice:

- What feels more like you when you live into your essence on purpose?
- How do others respond differently to your presence?
- Where do you catch yourself muting or softening, and what happens if you don't?

LIVING IT OUT, CONTINUED

End-of-Week Reflection:

What shifted this week — in how you carried yourself, and in how you were received?

What is one small way you want to keep living into your essence after this week is over?

THIS WEEK

For one day this week, intentionally embody your essence.

Choose clothing, music, or an environment that aligns with your God-given grace.

Observe how you feel — not how you look — when you live in harmony with it.



Closing Prayer

Heavenly Father,
Thank You for the gift of Your presence and grace
in my life.

Teach me to live as Your Temple, bringing glory
and honor to You.

Amen.



MY SACRED STYLE ESSENCE PORTRAIT

My Sacred Style Essence Blend

A way my presence has been serving others that I
have never named as a gift:

A part of my presence I have been muting or
apologizing for — and what I sense God is asking
me to do with it:

The facet of God my essence reflects — and what
that tells me about how He composed me:

Where I sense God asking me to inhabit my
presence more fully right now, in the actual
conditions of my life:

